Alex Fernsby

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Profile

Data engineer with 7 years of experience building batch and streaming pipelines for retail and logistics companies. Strongest in Python, SQL and Apache Airflow, with hands-on dbt modelling and Great Expectations testing in production. Comfortable owning a pipeline from ingestion through to the warehouse, and mentoring the engineers who build the next ones. Looking for a senior individual-contributor or tech-lead role on a data platform team, working on data quality, modelling and orchestration. Based in Rotterdam, open to hybrid roles in the Netherlands and remote across the EU.

Experience

Senior Data Engineer March 2022 – present
Tidewater Logistics, Rotterdam

- Own the shipment-events pipeline: 40 million events per day from Kafka into a PostgreSQL and BigQuery warehouse, orchestrated with Apache Airflow.
- Cut the nightly rebuild of the delivery-performance mart from 6 hours to 55 minutes by moving it to incremental dbt models.
- Introduced data-quality tests (Great Expectations) on 30 core tables; failed loads dropped 70 percent over two quarters.
- Mentor two junior engineers and lead the weekly data-modelling review.

Data Engineer June 2018 – February 2022
Marlow Retail Group, Utrecht

- Built the first Airflow deployment at the company and migrated 45 cron jobs onto it.
- Designed a customer-orders star schema in PostgreSQL used by 12 analysts.
- Wrote Python ingestion services for partner price feeds (REST and SFTP), handling about 2 million rows per day.
- Supported the move of the warehouse from on-premise PostgreSQL to BigQuery.

Junior Analyst September 2016 – May 2018
Delft Energy Cooperative, Delft

- Automated monthly consumption reports with Python and SQL, saving the team about 3 days each month.

Education

MSc Computer Science (data systems) 2016
Delft University of Technology

BSc Computer Science 2014
Delft University of Technology

Skills

- **Strong:** Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, Apache Airflow, dbt, Kafka, BigQuery, Great Expectations, Docker
- **Working:** Terraform, GitHub Actions, Looker, Pandas
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Dutch (native), German (basic)